Cortney for Congress — Campaign Photography Shot List

> ***Purpose:*** *Guide for a photographer or the campaign to capture the images needed to bring the website to life.*
> ***Current state:*** *The site has only 2 photos (headshot + wide headshot). It needs ~50-70 images to feel complete.*
> ***Last updated:*** *March 12, 2026*

The Narrative Arc

Voters should see Cortney as:

1. **A real person** — mom, nurse, neighbor
2. **A fighter** — rallies, speaking, passion
3. **A listener** — community events, one-on-ones, coffee conversations
4. **A leader** — podium, crowds behind her, statehouse testimony

The photos should tell that story across every page.

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1. HOMEPAGE

Hero (the single most important photo on the site)

#	Concept	Framing	Mood	Why
1	**"The Fighter's Gaze"** — Cortney standing outdoors in an Ohio setting, looking directly into camera, determined expression	Three-quarter body, shot from slightly below eye level, shallow depth of field	Fierce confidence, warm but uncompromising	This is the "first handshake." Below-eye-level angle is a classic power composition
2	**"Walking Into the Fight"** — Mid-stride on a working-class Ohio street, slight smile, looking just past camera	Full body, street level, environment tells the story	Forward momentum, approachable	Motion implies action — campaign is moving, not waiting
3	**"At the Kitchen Table"** — Sitting at a kitchen table, leaning forward, coffee mug, window light	Medium shot, waist up, warm color temperature	Intimate, relatable, "she's one of us"	The kitchen table is where working families make their hardest decisions
4	**"Arms Crossed, Ready"** — Classic power portrait against simple background (brick wall, sky)	Medium close-up, chest and up, eye level	Strong, no-nonsense, campaign-poster energy	Versatile "campaign mailer" shot

Meet Cortney Section

#	Concept	Framing	Mood	Why

1	**"Cortney with Her Sons"** — At a park or backyard, caught mid-laugh, crouching to talk to younger one	Medium-wide, candid, warm light	Tender, authentic mom energy	Voters need to feel she fights for their kids because she fights for her own
2	**"The Nurse"** — In scrubs or medical setting, leaning against a wall between patients	Medium shot, environmental	Hardworking, authentic	Her nursing career is her credibility on healthcare and wages
3	**"Hometown Girl"** — On a recognizable Ashtabula or Cleveland street, casual clothes, hands in pockets	Wide environmental portrait, she's smaller in frame	Grounded, local, "from here"	OH-11 voters need to know she's one of them

Accomplishments Section

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Spoke at the Statehouse"** — At or near Ohio Statehouse (Senate Bill 87 testimony)	Medium from below, building partially visible	Determined, "already doing the work"
2	**"Rally Crowd Shot"** — In the crowd at Public Square or anti-war rally, holding sign or speaking	Wide enough to show crowd	Solidarity, grassroots energy
3	**"Food Distribution"** — At The People's Distro, handing out food, loading boxes	Candid action shot	Compassion, service

Vision Section

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Working Ohio" Background** — Atmospheric wide shot of Ohio industrial landscape at golden hour	Ultra-wide landscape, dark overlay for text	Gritty, beautiful, working-class pride
2	**"Speaking with Passion"** — Close-up mid-speech, hands gesturing, eyes intense	Tight crop on face and upper body	Fiery, populist fury

Grassroots Pledge Section

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Volunteer Canvassers"** — 2-4 volunteers with clipboards walking a residential street	Wide, late afternoon light	Grassroots authenticity

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2. ISSUES PAGE

Hero

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Community Forum"** — At a podium in a VFW hall or community center, audience visible	Medium-wide, modest venue	Earnest, authoritative, accessible
2	**"Nurse in Thought"** — Profile in scrubs, looking out a window	Medium close-up, soft light	Contemplative, purposeful

Issue Section Accents

#	Concept	For Which Issue
1	**"At the Bedside"** — Hands in medical gloves, hospital corridor	Healthcare / Medicare for All
2	**"With Parents at School"** — Sitting with parents or visiting a classroom	Education
3	**"Ohio Neighborhoods"** — Row of working-class houses, porches, yards	Housing

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3. GET INVOLVED PAGE

Hero

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Volunteer Team Huddle"** — Cortney in a circle with 4-6 volunteers reviewing canvass maps	Medium-wide, showing full group	Inclusive, team spirit
2	**"Door Knock"** — Knocking on a door, clipboard in hand, resident visible	Medium from the side	Friendly, grassroots

Ways to Help Cards

Card	Photo Concept
Canvassing	Two people walking a residential street with clipboards
Phone Banking	A volunteer on the phone at a table with call script visible
Yard Signs	A Cortney for Congress sign in a residential yard (when produced)

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4. ENDORSEMENTS PAGE

Hero

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Group of Supporters"** — 8-12 diverse people together, some with campaign signs. Mix of ages, races, occupations	Wide, natural setting	Unity, diversity of support

Endorser Cards

#	Concept	Notes

1	**Endorser headshots** — Simple, consistent framing, natural light, warm background	Faces next to quotes build trust. Consistent aspect ratio across all endorsers

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5. EVENTS PAGE

Hero

#	Concept	Framing	Mood
1	**"Coffee & Conversation"** — Cortney at a cafe table, engaged with someone	Medium through a window or across the room	Accessible, warm
2	**"St. Patrick's Day Canvass"** — Campaign team in green at the Cleveland celebration	Wide, capturing crowd energy	Fun, community

Event Card Thumbnails

Event Type	Photo Concept
Community	Farmers market booth, campaign table with materials
Canvass	Clipboard canvassing walk on a street
Town Hall	Community space with chairs and podium setup
Coffee	Cafe table, two people talking

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6. GALLERY PAGE — Needs 20-30+ Photos

The gallery has a working lightbox and filter system but only 2 real photos. This is where the bulk of photography goes.

"Cortney" Filter

#	Concept	Mood
1	**Official Portrait — Formal** — Studio quality, clean background, professional attire	Professional, confident
2	**Official Portrait — Casual** — Same quality, casual clothes, natural setting	Relaxed, authentic
3	**Mom Life** — Grocery shopping, playground, making dinner, helping with homework	Intimate, relatable
4	**Cortney Laughing** — Genuine unguarded laugh, caught mid-joy	Warmth, humanity

"Campaign Trail" Filter

#	Concept	Mood
1	**Signature Collection** — Getting a signature on a petition, clipboard between them	Democratic process in action

2	**Door Knock Close-Up** — Hand reaching for doorbell, or on a porch introducing herself	Persistence, personal connection
3	**Van Loaded with Literature** — Back of car full of flyers, clipboards. The unglamorous reality	Scrappy, working-class campaign
4	**Walking the District** — Down a sidewalk, waving or talking to someone on a porch	On the ground, present

"Community" Filter

#	Concept	Mood
1	**People's Distro Food Distribution** — Loading boxes, handing out bags, talking with people	Service, compassion
2	**Coffee & Conversation** — Across the table from a voter, coffee cups visible	Warm, personal
3	**Cannabis Farmers Market** — Campaign table at 78th Street Studios, talking with attendees	Relaxed, community
4	**Neighborhood Gathering** — Backyard, 6-10 people in lawn chairs, Cortney in the group	House party energy
5	**Community Leaders** — Shaking hands with local figures (pastors, union reps, teachers)	Coalition building

"Events" Filter

#	Concept	Mood
1	**Public Square Rally** — ICE OUT! rally, Jan 30. Crowd, signs, megaphones	Solidarity, people power
2	**Statehouse Testimony** — Speaking against SB 87, Feb 18. At the podium, chamber visible	Serious, "already doing the work"
3	**Anti-War Rally** — March 7 at Market Square. Signs, speakers, crowd	Moral clarity
4	**Event Setup/Breakdown** — Setting up chairs, putting out literature. Not just arriving as "the candidate"	Authenticity, "she carries her own chairs"

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7. PRESS PAGE

Downloadable Assets (High-Res for Media)

#	Concept	Technical Notes
1	**Studio Headshot** — Properly lit, neutral background. Publication-ready	Must be 3000px+ wide for print. Portrait AND landscape crops
2	**Action Shot** — Speaking at a podium or rally. Sharp focus, clean composition	Multiple orientations for different layouts

3	**Campaign Trail Set** — 3-4 photos: canvassing, speaking, listening, with voters	Mix of tight and wide, all high-res

Pull Quote Section

#	Concept	Mood
1	**Close-Up Profile** — Side-lit, looking into distance. Lots of negative space for text overlay	Thoughtful, powerful, editorial

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8. BLOG POSTS

#	Concept	Notes
1	**Post card thumbnails** — One photo per blog post for the listing page	Wide landscape, 1200x630px minimum
2	**Post-specific event photos** — Each blog post about an event uses a photo from that event as its header	Match the post content

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9. SOCIAL SHARING (og:image)

#	Concept	Notes
1	**Campaign Card** — Designed graphic: best headshot + logo + name + tagline	Exactly 1200x630px. Must look good at thumbnail size. This is the most-seen campaign image

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The Essential 15 — Must-Have Campaign Photos

Every congressional campaign needs these in the bank:

#	Shot	Used For
1	**Studio Headshot** — Clean background, professional lighting	Press, yard signs, Wikipedia, everywhere
2	**Environmental Portrait** — Full body in meaningful Ohio location	Homepage hero, about sections
3	**Family Photo** — With her two sons, authentic not stiff	About section, mailers, social
4	**Nursing/Work Photo** — In scrubs or medical setting	Issues page, bio, credibility
5	**Speaking at a Podium** — From below, showing authority	Press, events, endorsements
6	**One-on-One with a Voter** — Close, attentive, listening	Get involved, gallery, credibility
7	**Canvassing / Door-Knocking** — Clipboard, porch, talking to resident	Get involved, gallery, grassroots proof
8	**Rally / Crowd Shot** — Cortney visible in or in front of a crowd	Homepage, events, social

9	**Small Group Conversation** — 3-5 people, casual setting	Gallery, endorsements
10	**Volunteer Team Photo** — Campaign crew together, smiling	Get involved, social
11	**Walking the District** — On a sidewalk, in motion, looking ahead	Homepage, gallery
12	**Close-Up in Thought** — Profile, contemplative, not smiling	Press, vision section, gravitas
13	**Laughing / Joyful Moment** — Genuine, unguarded	Social, gallery, humanizes
14	**Behind the Scenes** — Reviewing notes, loading the car, setting up	Gallery, authenticity
15	**Ohio Landscape** — Cleveland skyline, Ashtabula harbor, neighborhoods	Backgrounds, atmosphere

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Shoot Priority (What to Schedule First)

1. **HIGHEST** — Studio/environmental portrait session (hero, press, og:image, headshot)
2. **HIGH** — Family/home life session (meet section, gallery, social)
3. **HIGH** — Cover every upcoming event:
    - Cannabis Farmers Market — March 14
    - St. Patrick's Day — March 17
    - Phoenix Coffee — March 22
4. **MEDIUM** — Canvass/volunteer day coverage (get-involved, gallery)
5. **MEDIUM** — Ohio district landscape shots (backgrounds)
6. **LOWER** — Nursing/work environment (if accessible)

Technical Requirements

- Shoot at highest resolution, compress to under 200KB for web
- Strip EXIF data before publishing (privacy + security)
- Provide portrait AND landscape crops of key shots
- Warm color temperature to match site's cream/plum/coral palette
- Alt text written for every image (accessibility + SEO)
- No stock-photo energy — documentary, not corporate
- No AI-generated images
- No American flag backgrounds — visual language is "Ohio working class" not "generic politician"
- No shots where she's alone in a crowd — always engaging with people

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